



THE EU AND UKRAINE

June 2026

Ukraine is an **EU candidate country** since 2022.



STRONG AND CONTINUED EU SUPPORT FOR UKRAINE

The EU is one of Ukraine's strongest supporters. Since the start of Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine, the EU and its Member States made available **€204.8 billion** in **financial**, **humanitarian**, and **military assistance** to Ukraine and to cater for Ukrainians' needs in the EU.

UKRAINE FACILITY

The EU has established a dedicated financing instrument of up to **€50 billion** to provide predictable and flexible support to Ukraine for the period 2024-2027 to support its recovery, reconstruction and modernisation, in line with its EU path. The Ukraine Facility is operational since 1 March 2024, with **€29.5 billion** committed to date.

Under its **first pillar**, the Ukraine Facility supports the implementation of the **Ukraine Plan** through grants and loans to Ukraine's budget. The Ukraine Plan is Ukraine's strategy for the modernisation and recovery of the country. This addresses the most urgent financial needs of the State and helps maintaining macro-financial stability. It also supports investments to foster recovery and reconstruction linked with the EU accession process.



The EU is Ukraine's

largest trade partner

largest investor

largest provider of financial assistance

The **second pillar**, the **Ukraine Investment Framework**, is equipped with **€9.3 billion** in guarantees and grants and aims to mobilise up to **€40 billion** in public and private investment for Ukraine's recovery and reconstruction in cooperation with EU Member States, the Government of Ukraine and International Financial Institutions (including the European national development banks).

Under the **third pillar**, the EU has allocated **€4.76 billion**, focusing on providing technical assistance and support to help Ukraine align with EU laws and regulations. This includes capacity-building initiatives, support for implementing EU accession reforms, and assistance in responding to Russian aggression against Ukraine. The pillar also provides interest rate subsidies for the cost of loans provided to Ukraine by the Facility or previous macro-financial assistance instrument.

Likewise, in the framework of the G7-led **Extraordinary Revenue Acceleration Loan Initiative** (ERA), which will generate **€45 billion** in loans from the profits of immobilised Russian sovereign assets, the EU will contribute with **€18.1 billion** in new macro-financial assistance (MFA) to Ukraine in 2025. So far, the EU has made available **€3.7 billion** generated from immobilised Russian assets in support of Ukraine, with the largest share provided through the European Peace Facility and the remainder via the Ukraine Facility.



CLOSE TRADE & INVESTMENT LINKS

The EU is Ukraine's **main trading partner**, accounting for over 50% of its trade in goods in 2024, equivalent to €67.2 billion – more than double the level recorded since the **Deep and Comprehensive Free Trade Area** entered into force in 2016.

On 29 October 2025, an **upgraded DCFTA** became effective, bringing further mutually beneficial trade liberalisation and deeper alignment of Ukrainian and EU production standards, while fully taking into account the sensitivity of certain EU agricultural sectors. This marks **another key step towards Ukraine's gradual integration into the EU Single Market**.

The **Priority Action Plan** for enhanced implementation of the EU-Ukraine DCFTA in 2025-2026 lays down a set of concrete actions to monitor the full implementation of the DCFTA and to provide Ukraine with further access to the EU Single Market.

In response to the global food security threat posed by Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine and the blockade of its seaports which hindered traditional export routes, the **EU-Ukraine Solidarity Lanes** were established as part of the solidarity response to facilitate Ukraine's export and import of goods through alternative rail, road, and inland waterway channels.

According to Ukrainian customs registers, since May 2022 the Solidarity Lanes have enabled Ukraine to export about **220 million tonnes** of goods, including nearly 93 million tonnes of grain, oilseeds and other related products, and to import around 104 million tonnes of goods it needs. The total value of trade via the Solidarity Lanes since May 2022 is **around €282 billion**, including around €208 billion imports to Ukraine.

GLOBAL GATEWAY

The EU's Global Gateway supports investments and mobilises the private sector and international financing institutions towards more resilient economies. It delivers concrete benefits for people in areas such as transport, energy, environment and climate, water and sanitation and digital development. Since 2021, the EU has mobilised **€6.58 billion** for Global Gateway projects in Ukraine, together with international financial institutions. Ongoing investments include:

- **Upgrading border crossing points** to ensure the safe transport of Ukrainian exports and the import of essential goods under the EU's Solidarity Lanes initiative.
- **Building a 22 km railway with the EU's standard** EU track width of 1,435 mm gauge to link Uzhhorod and Chop to the EU network, including **modernised signalling, communication, and centralised control systems**.
- **Supporting** Ukrenergo and other companies in restoring and strengthening **power generation and infrastructure**.
- **Improving energy efficiency in buildings** to boost Ukraine's energy independence and cut costs and waste.
- Conducting **emergency repairs on war-damaged apartment buildings** and refurbishing housing for internally displaced persons.

HUMANITARIAN AND CIVIL PROTECTION

Since February 2022, the Commission has allocated over **€1.1 billion** for humanitarian aid programmes in Ukraine to be implemented by partners on the ground. In line with the priorities of the Ukrainian government, EU humanitarian assistance provides shelter, cash support, healthcare, food assistance, education, water and sanitation.

SUPPORT FOR RESILIENCE AND CIVIL SOCIETY

Following Russia's aggression, the EU swiftly implemented the Temporary Protection Directive, granting people fleeing Ukraine residency, work permits, housing, healthcare, and education in the EU. Over **four million Ukrainians** have been welcomed, with protection extended until March 2027. The Commission has introduced maximum flexibility so that Member States can support people fleeing the war using unspent cohesion funds, thus making available up to **€17 billion**.

The EU has stepped up support to bolster Ukraine's cyber resilience, delivering €10 million worth of equipment, software, and related assistance. An additional €19 million has been allocated to foster resilient digital transformation, while €31 million has been directed to civil society through the Civil Society and Human Rights and Democracy thematic programmes.

The EU has funded over **11,500** exchanges between EU and Ukrainian citizens in the areas of education, training, youth, and sport under **ERASMUS+** since 2021.

SUPPORTING UKRAINE'S ENERGY RESILIENCE

Over **€3 billion** of support for energy security has already been provided to Ukraine since Russia's full-scale invasion, via the Ukraine Energy Support Fund and the Union Civil Protection Mechanism, among others.

SUPPORT FOR MILITARY EQUIPMENT AND TRAINING

The EU is the biggest investor in Ukraine's defence industry. The EU and its Member States have mobilised **€63.2 billion** in **military support** for Ukraine, including €6.1 billion under the European Peace Facility. The EU Military Assistance Mission for Ukraine is tackling training needs of the Ukrainian Armed Forces and has trained over **80,000 Ukrainian soldiers**. Likewise, the EU will frontload **€6 billion** from the G7-led ERA loans initiative and enter into a **Drone Alliance** with Ukraine.

